

cific solution. In such cases, developers can use APIs or other integrations to add their code or models to the platform. This would, however, require additional technical expertise to set up and configure properly.

The addition of third-party services and APIs to provide additional functions or integration with other platforms increases the risk of security breaches. Some LCNC AI tools require users to upload sensitive data, such as customer information or financial data. This data can be at risk if proper security measures are not put in place. Built-in security features, such as data encryption, can protect sensitive data and prevent any cyber-attacks.

In case of low code, developers use software development tools that ease monitoring by security teams. A full static or dynamic analysis becomes tough for platform-generated code. Such a situation could lead to new threats, such as data leaks and potential compliance violations, which may escape the notice of security teams. Limiting and monitoring access controls along with involving security and identity teams in the application design process could prevent any illicit privilege use.

Chahal believes that deploying a few important guardrails like auditability, lineage, and role based execution around the design, and deployment of automation tasks could help minimise any security implications. Adopting service providers that offer security controls, such as data encryption, identity federation, and logging, can also mitigate the risks that come with the adoption of low-code/no-code AI platforms.

Giving an example of how IBM's low-code/no-code platforms provide the features to audit the machine learning models, Chahal elaborates, "These platforms de-bias the data used to train the machine learning models and maintain the lineage

of the data and information that gets exchanged through an automated task. The automation tasks are mapped to user roles and thus provide access mechanism and authorisation to design and execute these tasks."

By establishing data quality standards, investing in the right human resources and tools for model deployment and management, and incorporating machine learning into existing IT systems, enterprises can easily sail through these challenges.

Embracing the future

The International Data Corporation (IDC) released a report earlier in January this year, forecasting a \$21 billion growth in 2026 in the worldwide market for low-code, no-code, and intelligent developer technologies (LCNCIDT). The report stated that the demand for these technologies would allow the revenue to grow at a five-year compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of 17.8% from 2021 to 2026.

In India, the low-code/no-code market has been growing at a CAGR of 15% since 2019. It generated a revenue of around \$400 million during FY21 for IT service providers and startups, according to a NASSCOM report published in March 2022.

"The market for LCNCIDT technologies is being driven by the global shortage of full-time developers," says Michele Rosen, Research Manager of low-code, no-code, and intelligent developer technologies at IDC. She expects this situation to persist through this decade to create a big market for technologies that improve developer output and increase the potential number of developers.

The adoption of low-code/no-code AI platforms, to optimise development and equip non-technical developers with tools to create and modify digital solutions, will

further be propelled by extensive growth in AI, which is becoming the fundamental element of all technology offerings. Vijan adds that the enhancement of developer productivity and the speed at which AI based solutions are being created using LCNC AI tools have paved the way for the creation of personalised AI based solutions.

"With LCNC AI platforms and tools, applications can be created without prior technical knowledge in AI development. While large language models like GPT3 and GPT4 can create websites from a sketch, they are not widely used in the industry currently. However, the quick release of productivity solutions in the near future will improve internal process efficiency by enhancing competency with AI-assisted coding and raising baseline offers with AI solutions," he says.

To build a successful business, entrepreneurs and business owners need to adopt new and unique ways of digital transformation. It's no secret that AI-assisted development in a business enhances productivity, increases ROI, and reduces costs. Low-code/no-code AI platforms and tools are merely skimming through the top layer of the vast ocean of disruptive technologies.

Despite that, it is interesting to note how AI-powered LCNC technologies remove the pertinent debate of AI replacing humans. The scarcity of skilled developers has created an urgency for everyone to learn and implement tools that reduce the time, intricacies, and cost of delivering solutions. AI-powered LCNC tools democratise access to technology for a wider pool of users, providing a chance for businesses of all sizes to stay competitive in today's fast-paced digital environment. **EFY**

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